



I failed my Stanford math midterm

1 message

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To: Nellie <nelliemkamburi@gmail.com>

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Nellie,

I was a math nerd in high school.

Founder of my school's math tutoring club, decorating my AP calc and stats notes with colorful pens, plotting my feelings on a graph so I could analyze trends over time, and geeking out over how math trains me to be a better thinker.

But Stanford math felt... different.

I entered the class (MATH 21 btw) as a sophomore, the room filled with excited freshmen who all seemed to grasp the material easily and asked complex questions to the professor I couldn't even understand.

I stared at my midterm in complete shock. When did we even LEARN this stuff in class??

For the first time, I got a pretty bad score. (Luckily the class was curved.)

But this was when it really hit me that I was in a completely different educational environment.

ALL of these kids had also gotten into Stanford for THEIR intellectual curiosity.

I had nowhere near the kind of knowledge and skill some of these kids had when it came to math. I was also not passionate about it in the way that math majors were.

And at that moment, I felt so thankful that I DIDN'T write my Stanford intellectual vitality college essay on my love for math.

I was actually advised against it.

Here's the thing: college admissions is lowkey a game, right? So you have to know how to play to your strengths in relation to everyone else.

So sure, I loved math. I was good at it in school.

But I didn't spend my free time learning new radical concepts. I didn't work out my own math formulas or memorize the Rubix cube algorithm or read math textbooks for fun. And I was definitely NOT going to major in math.

Math is one of those subjects that a LOT of people like to write about, especially at a school known for engineering.

So for me to stand out, I needed to focus on MY true strength, which at the time was art and design.

I crafted an essay about my intellectual process for graphic designing a yearbook cover. And I am confident that this was the best decision in order to create a cohesive application.

But guess what!

I still wanted to tie in my analytical left brain with my creative right brain, so in my essay, I showed how my design process reflected mathematical processes. I found ways to work in mathematical language when talking about the vector graphics I was designing in Photoshop.

It's all about building connections between your interests within your application.

If you wanna read the essay and hear me analyze it, watch [THIS VIDEO](#) !

If I hadn't known this key strategy, I might not be a rising senior at Stanford right now.

Strategy is how you truly stand out in college admissions.

If you are ready to learn the strategy for yourself, I invite you to apply to work with us and access my **free private training**. I'll be going over the 4 components you need for a stand-out app!

Apply to work with us & unlock my free private training!

Oh, and one last thing...

Don't worry too much if you fail a math test.

Failing and making mistakes is the only way you learn and grow.

Behind every success is a dozen more failures.

So don't just believe what you see on the outside ;)

Best,

Dyllen | NextGenAdmit.com

College Admissions Coach



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P.S. If you wanna read the intellectual vitality essay that got me into Stanford and watch me analyze it, watch **THIS VIDEO!**

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